



Supercomputer running on light

Jean Zay supercomputer is now the first HPC to use light for transmitting and processing information. <https://dgit.in/jan22-11>



No more BlackBerryOS support

As of January 4, BlackBerry has pulled support for BlackBerryOS phones. <https://dgit.in/jan22-12>

ASUS Expertbook B1 B1400

The everyday knight

By design, thin and light laptops are usually office laptops, but thanks to the latest revolution in CPU technology, these laptops are capable of a lot more. The ASUS Expertbook B1400 is one such capable laptop we recently tested and here's our opinion on whether you should buy it or not.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The ASUS Expertbook B1400 features an aluminium lid on top and a steel support bracket for the keyboard. It has a solid hinge and its screen has minimal flex. The laptop's base also feels very sturdy and on its surface has a matte-absorbent coating, which makes typing on it for long hours very easy. With an overall weight of 1.45 kg, the laptop is quite portable.

The Expertbook's keyboard has a 1.5mm key travel and is ideal for most use cases. The trackpad is also decent. The Expert Book B1400 laptop series also features an ASUS Numberpad 2.0, a secondary digital touchpad. However, our particular unit came with a normal trackpad and it works fine.

ASUS has imbued the Expertbook B1400 with a webcam lid and fingerprint sensor over the power button. Both of them work as intended. The laptop also has an onboard mic with an AI noise-cancelling feature that filters background noise. We tested it and found that it did filter out a good chunk of ambient noise from the fan and AC.

DISPLAY

The display is one area where the Expertbook B1400 laptop lets you down. It comes with a 14-inch 1080p display with just 232 nits of brightness. The laptop's screen has a 178° viewing angle but some portions of the screen become darker when you view it sideways. The laptop's screen covers 64.7



laptop in performance mode, the screen's colour set to "vivid" and brightness to 100 percent. The laptop managed a battery life of 4h and 21 minutes.

In our second attempt, we put the laptop in balanced mode, changed the screen's colour setting to "Normal" and reduced the brightness to 80 percent. Now, the laptop returned a battery life of 7h and 28 minutes. Therefore, we'd put this laptop's battery life somewhere around 7 hours in real-world usage, which is pretty good.

percent sRGB and 47.7 percent DCI-P3 colour spectrum. During the Colorchecker analysis, we also found that the laptop's screen is not colour accurate.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of performance, it has an Intel 11th Gen Core i5-1135G7 CPU. The CPU has a 28W TDP and also packs in the Intel Iris Xe discrete graphics chip.

The quad-core Intel CPU uses the most power during photo editing, gaming, rendering and visualisation. Under normal usage which includes opening and closing different applications, the CPU power usage remains at around 15W. However, during web browsing, it shoots up to 35W.

In real-life scenarios, the laptop handles all the basic tasks like photo editing, video editing and web browsing very well.

We also tested some games like Shadow of the Tomb Raider and it scored about 29 FPS. Meanwhile, titles like Valorant and Fortnite ran easily at around 90 to 60 FPS respectively at low settings in 1080p resolution.

BATTERY

We tested the laptop's battery life two times. In the first test, we put the



BUILD	76
FEATURES	77
PERFORMANCE	70
VALUE	74

VERDICT

The ASUS Expertbook B1400 is a well-built laptop with decent performance and high portability. Its small size and

high build quality make it a good daily driver and its impeccable keyboard makes working on it for hours a bliss. The laptop's low-brightness screen is a letdown. However, its decent battery life, good I/O port selection and high build quality make up for it.

We'd suggest you to connect an external monitor, a mouse and a keyboard to this laptop and use it as a work PC thanks to its great I/O port selection. The laptop has an approximate price of ₹55,000. You can also check out Lenovo IdeaPad Slim 5i or Acer Aspire 5 as some other viable options.

—Yatnesh Dubey

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel 11th Gen Core i5-1135G7 CPU 4-core 8-thread with 2.40GHz base frequency and 4.20GHz Max Turbo frequency | GRAPHICS CARD: Intel Iris Xe graphics card running at 1.30GHz frequency | MEMORY: 8GB DDR4 RAM | STORAGE: 512GB SSD | DISPLAY: 14-inch 1080p IPS LCD display | WEIGHT: 1.45kg

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